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www.linkedin.com/in/rskyex
(LinkedIn)
risakoyanagi.com/ (Portfolio)
govern-the-human.vercel.app/
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(Company)
github.com/rskyex (Portfolio)

Top Skills

Quantum Information
Quantum Theory
Quantum Computation

Languages

English (Native or Bilingual)
Japanese (Native or Bilingual)
Chinese (Limited Working)
Russian (Elementary)

Certifications

McKinsey.org Forward Program
Professional Certification AGI
Strategy
Generative AI for Data Analysis
Professional Certificate
Cybersecurity Specialization
Certificate

Honors-Awards

Thing Big undergraduate
International Scholarship
2nd Proze of Tokyo Natural Disaster
Policy Proposal 2days GEIL
CCIR Social Science Scholarship
Selected by Monster Exhibition 2021
Academist Prize 6th Cohort

Risa Koyanagi

Space / Cyber Governance, HSPS @Cambridge | ISEB JAXA 2026
| SG[Japan] Space Policy Team Lead | Intern @Morgan Stanley /
METI
United Kingdom

Summary

Risa Koyanagi is a researcher / student at the University of Cambridge. She studies emerging technologies governance, with a particular focus on how authority is constructed, how norms break down, and what it takes to rebuild legitimacy after they do. Her research spans dual-use infrastructure, cross-domain escalation risk, and structural gaps in responsible behavior norms. She conducts supervised research at the Cambridge Centre for International Research under Prof. Harald Wydra on legitimation in lunar governance, and was selected by Japanese Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA) as a delegate to the International Space Education Board (ISEB) at the International Astronautical Congress 2026 (IAC). She leads the Space Policy Project Team for SG[Japan]. Her perspective is grounded in fieldwork in post-disaster Fukushima, where she examined how governance failures at the state-operator interface erode public trust, conducting interviews with evacuees, municipal officials, and TEPCO and METI representatives. She builds open research platforms. Faultline operationalises escalation theory and attribution through the Orbital Risk Tracker, the Global Nuclear Infrastructure Atlas, and the Cyber Escalation Atlas. Govern the Human examines how sustained AI interaction transforms the human subject meant to govern, consent, and deliberate. She is also Morgan Stanley Summer Intern 2026 / Ministry of Economy and Trade of Japan Policy Analysis Intern 2026 / Financial Services Agency Japan Financial Administration Intern 2026. She is the former president of AFRECOS, a youth network spanning more than 10 countries, delivered a brief at Japan's House of Councillors

Experience

Morgan Stanley
Summer Intern
July 2026 - Present (1 month)

Tokyo, Japan

JAXA: Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency

International Space Education Board

May 2026 - Present (3 months)

Antalya, Türkiye

Selected by JAXA as a delegate to the International Space Education Board (ISEB), the coordinating body that brings together leading space agencies including NASA, ESA, and JAXA. Represent Japan in international dialogue on space education and next-generation workforce development at the International Astronautical Congress, the world's largest space conference. Engage directly with agency representatives and early-career professionals across member organisations to support cross-agency education and capacity-building initiatives.

Ministry of Economy, Trade and Industry

Policy Analysis Intern

July 2026 - Present (1 month)

Tokyo, Japan

Space Generation Advisory Council

Space Policy Project Team Leader SG[Japan]

April 2026 - Present (4 months)

Tokyo, Japan

Lead the Japan team of SGAC's 2026 Space Policy Project, the council's flagship channel for delivering youth policy positions to the international space community. Coordinate a multidisciplinary team through research, drafting, and review to produce a written policy position on space governance. Set the analytical direction, manage timelines and contributions, and synthesise members' input into a coherent submission for policymakers and the wider sector.

Cambridge Centre for International Research

Researcher - Legitimation in Lunar Governance

September 2025 - June 2026 (10 months)

Cambridgeshire

Conduct supervised research under Prof. Harald Wydra on how universalist language in competing lunar governance frameworks ("Who Speaks for Humanity on the Moon?") is translated into technical standards, participation conditions, and interpretive discretion. Designed a structured qualitative

codebook and conducted primary-source analysis of US and Chinese policy documents to trace how shared vocabulary conceals divergent governance claims. Synthesise findings for both academic and policy audiences, with work accepted for presentation at leading international space and security venues.

TIES

Young Research Fellow - Geopolitics of Narrative building

April 2026 - May 2026 (2 months)

New Delhi

Conduct independent research on the geopolitics of narrative formation in strategic competition, with a focus on satellite and space-based capabilities in the Indo-Pacific. Produce analytical outputs for a multinational research network, examining how states construct and contest strategic narratives around emerging technologies. Translate cross-domain findings into accessible briefings for academic and policy audiences.

UN Women

Asia and the Pacific Office AI Program

May 2025 - August 2025 (4 months)

Bangkok

Contributed to AI policy research within the regional office's AI programme, focusing on governance frameworks for emerging technologies. Examined how AI policy intersects with rights, inclusion, and development priorities across the region, supporting the programme's analysis of responsible technology governance. Produced written research inputs to inform the office's policy positioning.

Association of African Economy & Development Student Committee (AFRECOS)

Co-Founder and President

January 2024 - December 2024 (1 year)

Founded and led a youth network spanning more than 10 countries, based in Tokyo and focused on Africa and Japan relations. Built the organisation from the ground up, organising cultural events of 70 to 80 attendees and delivering a policy address at Japan's House of Councillors. Represented AFRECOS at the TICAD Ministerial Meeting, proposing a Hiroshima, Fukushima, and Africa student exchange programme on nuclear ethics to an audience including government officials, UNDP, the World Bank, and African diplomatic missions.

Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Japan

Youth Representative at TICAD Ministerial Meeting

June 2024 - August 2024 (3 months)

Tokyo, Japan

Represented youth perspectives at the TICAD Ministerial Meeting convened by Japan's Ministry of Foreign Affairs. Proposed a Hiroshima, Fukushima, and Africa student exchange programme on nuclear ethics to an audience including government officials, UNDP, the World Bank, and African embassies, linking Japan's post-disaster experience to international development and youth diplomacy.

上智大学 Sophia University

Chairman of Peacebuilding Research Lab

April 2023 - August 2024 (1 year 5 months)

Tokyo, Japan

Chaired the Peacebuilding Circle under the supervision of Prof. Daisaku Higashi, leading a seminar series on conflict and recovery in Ukraine, Afghanistan, Iraq, and Sudan. Designed and facilitated structured dialogues bringing together Ukrainian, Russian, and Palestinian students and faculty, creating space for difficult cross-perspective conversation. Set the intellectual agenda for the series and sustained a forum for student engagement with contemporary peacebuilding.

I am now an alumni head

Independent

Field Researcher - Fukushima Post-Disaster Governance

July 2019 - August 2024 (5 years 2 months)

Fukushima, Japan

Conducted six years of multi-site fieldwork on post-disaster governance, trust gaps, and recovery policy in Fukushima. Carried out semi-structured interviews with evacuees, mayors, and officials from METI and TEPCO, building a primary-source account of the state and operator interface. Identified how the co-location of nuclear promotion and regulation undermined risk oversight and public trust, an analysis published in the local magazine. Organised a field study tour of 11 participants to Namie and Iwaki to connect outside researchers with affected communities.

Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Japan

Speaker at Japan-Netherlands Peace Exchange Program

October 2023 - October 2023 (1 month)

Gave a speech on Japan-Dutch Relations for Dutch Internees during the Pacific War in Japan-Netherlands Peace Program by Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Japan, in front of 50+ people.

Education

University of Cambridge

Bachelor's Degree, Human, Social and Political Sciences · (June 2026)

King's College London

Master of Arts, International Affairs: Cyber Security · (July 2026 - September 2026)

Saïd Business School, University of Oxford

Certificate, AI and Digital Transformation in the Government · (December 2022 - January 2023)

The London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE)

Bachelor of Science - BS, Politics and International Relations · (September 2025 - June 2026)

SOAS University of London

Foundation Degree, Social Sciences · (July 2024 - June 2025)